

Radeon 6000

AMD to launch the upcoming Radeon HD6000 series of cards in 2010

30nm DDR3

Samsung said to start manufacturing 30nm DDR3 modules soon

Are antiviruses going to die?

With the widespread adoption of open source operating systems that are inherently less vulnerable to virus attacks and Microsoft offering its own brand of security in the form of Microsoft Security Essentials, one wonders whether anti-viruses are really necessary. This month, we set out to answer this very question by featuring opinions from a wide cross section of the industry – from OS makers to anti-virus companies themselves

Amit Nath

Country Manager, India & SAARC,
Trend Micro



The answer is no. I have few questions before someone agrees to my thought. Has the threat landscape changed? Has it become more complex? Are the customers still being attacked? Have we solved the customer problem? If the answer to all the above questions is yes, then how can possibly AV die.

The roll out of a new technology means more complex needs of customers. Virtualisation is the new standard and with that, a new paradigm will be needed for security. As cyber crime is all about money, new social engineering malware attacks will bring in more challenges for security vendors. They will have to continuously come out with carefully crafted solutions to stay ahead of the curve.

Venkatasubrahmanyam Krishnapur

Senior Director – Engineering, McAfee

The threats to the cyber world have only been growing in nature and sophistication over the years. We expect to see AV co-exist, though likely on a diminishing scale, with increasing emphasis on pro-active anti-malware technology resulting in superior and faster protection to customers against a wider range of threats. McAfee has a head start in this area given that our solutions



are integrated with McAfee Global Threat Intelligence which offers our customers real-time protection and peace of mind

Rajiv Popli

Director, Windows Client, Consumer & Online Business Microsoft India

According to a recent CERT-In report, 1900 web sites have been defaced in the first three months of 2010 – a growth of over 500 percent, when compared to last year. Stats like these reinforce the need for consumers to protect themselves when surfing online. Also, socially engineered online security threats today are no longer limited to malware, phishing or Trojans you have newer threats / viruses evolving with every passing day. So, having an antivirus is imperative in ensuring the security of your



PC and personal data.

Apart from this, consumers need to keep their antiviruses and even OS up to date with service packs. However, the fact remains that as long as we have cyber crime, antiviruses will remain relevant in protecting consumers against cyber-threats.

Prakash Advani

Partner Manager - Central Asia,
Canonical

Linux is less effected by viruses than other operating systems for two reasons. The first is popularity - the virus makers of the world know that they can affect more systems more quickly by creating viruses for the most popular operating system, namely windows. The second is technical. There are inherent strengths in how Linux is built that makes it less vulnerable to those viruses



that are created to target Linux users.

For example, in a Linux system, user data and applications are separate, user can read and execute the applications but not write to them. For a virus to be successful, it needs to go and attach itself to all the executables. In Ubuntu we have an additional level of security by having sudo, whereby the root (admin) user is disabled by default.

I have been using Linux for the last 14 years and have never been affected by any